

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	13 — वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct.

Classic P5 traps: chaining multi-syllable मात्रा counts where ए ऐ ओ औ each weigh 2 (never 1) while अनुस्वार/विसर्ग weigh 0 yet still force गुरु-by-position; separating syllable-WEIGHT (गुरु/लघु) from vowel-DURATION (मात्रा); reading गुरु from what CLOSES a short vowel (conjunct/अनुस्वार/विसर्ग AFTER it), not an onset cluster before it; and cross-classifying वर्ण by उच्चारण-स्थान (कण्ठ्य/तालव्य/मूर्धन्य/दन्त्य/ओष्ठ्य) versus स्वर/व्यञ्जन. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Count the total मात्रा in रघुनन्दनः (vowels: अ in र, उ in घु, अ in नन्, अ in द, अ in नः; note नन् has short अ before the conjunct न्द).

(A) 5 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 4 मात्रा

2. Count the total मात्रा in सरस्वती (vowels: अ in स, अ in रस्, अ in व, ई in ती; रस् carries short अ before the conjunct स्व).

(A) 4 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 3 मात्रा

(D) 5 मात्रा

3. Count the total मात्रा in नारायणः (vowels: आ in ना, आ in रा, अ in य, अ in णः).

(A) 6 मात्रा

(B) 5 मात्रा

(C) 4 मात्रा

(D) 8 मात्रा

4. Count the total मात्रा in the two-word line रामः वनम् (vowels: आ in रा, अ in मः, अ in व, अ in नम्).

(A) 4 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 5 मात्रा

(D) 7 मात्रा

5. Count the total मात्रा in महादेवः (vowels: अ in म, आ in हा, ए in दे, अ in वः).

(A) 5 मात्रा

(B) 4 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 6 मात्रा

6. Count the total मात्रा in गौतमः (vowels: औ in गौ, अ in त, अ in मः).

(A) 3 मात्रा

(B) 5 मात्रा

(C) 4 मात्रा

(D) 6 मात्रा

7. Count the total मात्रा in विद्योत्साहः (vowels: इ in वि, ओ in द्यो, आ in त्सा, अ in हः; द्यो and त्सा carry conjuncts).

(A) 5 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 4 मात्रा

8. Count the total मात्रा in the line सूर्यः उदेति (vowels: ऊ in सू, अ in र्यः, उ in उ, ए in दे, इ in ति).

(A) 7 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 5 मात्रा

(D) 8 मात्रा

9. Count the total मात्रा in पाण्डवाः (vowels: आ in पा, अ in ण्ड... actually पा long आ, ण्ड closes to a syllable, वाः long आ; vowels are आ, अ, आ).

(A) 4 मात्रा

(B) 5 मात्रा

(C) 6 मात्रा

(D) 3 मात्रा

10. Count the total मात्रा in उपवनम् (vowels: उ in उ, अ in प, अ in व, अ in नम्).

(A) 5 मात्रा

(B) 4 मात्रा

(C) 3 मात्रा

(D) 6 मात्रा

11. Count the total मात्रा in केशवायनम् (vowels: ए in के, अ in श, आ in वा, अ in य, अ in नम्).

(A) 7 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 5 मात्रा

(D) 8 मात्रा

12. Count the total मात्रा in भारतीयः (vowels: आ in भा, अ in र, ई in ती, अ in यः).

(A) 5 मात्रा

(B) 4 मात्रा

(C) 6 मात्रा

(D) 7 मात्रा

13. Count the total मात्रा in जगदीशः (vowels: अ in ज, अ in ग, ई in दी, अ in शः).

(A) 4 मात्रा

(B) 5 मात्रा

(C) 6 मात्रा

(D) 3 मात्रा

14. Count the total मात्रा in the line माता पुत्रम् पश्यति (vowels: आ in मा, आ in ता, उ in पु, अ in त्रम्, अ in प, अ in श्य, इ in ति).

(A) 8 मात्रा

(B) 10 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 9 मात्रा

15. Count the total मात्रा in गोपीनाथः (vowels: ओ in गो, ई in पी, आ in ना, अ in थः).

(A) 6 मात्रा

(B) 8 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 5 मात्रा

16. Count the total मात्रा in चन्द्रशेखरः (vowels: अ in चन्, अ in द्र... चन् short अ before conjunct च्, द्र short अ, ए in शे, अ in ख, अ in रः; vowels अ, अ, ए, अ, अ).

(A) 5 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 4 मात्रा

17. Scan कमलानि (क + म + ला + नि) into its लघु(ल)/गुरु(ग) pattern.

(A) ल ल ल ल — all light because no syllable ends in a consonant

(B) ग ल ग ल — the first syllable is also heavy (C) ल ल ग ग — both of the last two are heavy

(D) ल ल ग ल — क light, म light, ला heavy by the long आ, नि light

18. Scan विद्यालयः (वि + द्या + ल + यः) into लघु/गुरु.

(A) ग ग ल ग — वि is heavy because the conjunct द्य follows it

(B) ल ग ल ल — the final यः is light because अ is short

(C) ल ग ल ग — वि light, द्या heavy by long आ, ल light, यः heavy by विसर्ग

(D) ल ल ल ग — द्या is light because अ... no long vowel

19. Scan देवदूतः (दे + व + दू + तः) into लघु/गुरु.

(A) ग ल ग ल — the final तः is light because अ is short

(B) ल ल ग ग — दे is light because ए is short

(C) ग ल ग ग — दे heavy by long ए, व light, दू heavy by long ऊ, तः heavy by विसर्ग

(D) ग ग ग ग — every syllable is heavy

20. Scan अनन्तरम् (अ + नन् + त + र्म्) into लघु/गुरु.

(A) ल ग ग ग — त is also heavy

(B) ल ल ल ग — only the last syllable is heavy

(C) ल ग ल ग — अ light/open, नन् heavy by the conjunct न्त, त light, र्म् heavy by the final म्

(D) ग ग ल ग — the first अ is heavy

21. Scan पुस्तकालयः (पुस् + त + का + ल + यः) into लघु/गुरु.

(A) ग ल ग ल ग — पुस् heavy by the conjunct स्त, त light, का heavy by long आ, ल light, यः heavy by विसर्ग

(B) ल ल ग ल ग — पुस् is light because उ is short (C) ग ल ग ल ल — the final यः is light

(D) ग ग ल ग — त is also heavy

22. Scan सङ्गीतम् (सङ् + गी + तम्) into लघु/गुरु.

(A) ल ग ग — सङ् is light because अ is short

(B) ग ग ग — सङ् heavy by the conjunct ङ्, गी heavy by long ई, तम् heavy by the final म्

(C) ग ग ल — the final तम् is light

(D) ल ग ल — only गी is heavy

23. Scan अम्बालिका (अम् + बा + लि + का) into लघु/गुरु.

(A) ल ग ल ग — अम् is light because अनुस्वार adds no मात्रा

(B) ग ग ल ग — अम् heavy by अनुस्वार, बा heavy by long आ, लि light, का heavy by long आ

(C) ग ग ग ग — every syllable is heavy (D) ल ग ल ल — only बा is heavy

24. Scan हरिश्चन्द्रः (ह + रिश् + चन् + द्रः) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ल ग ग ग — ह light, रिश् heavy by the conjunct श्च, चन् heavy by the conjunct द्र, द्रः heavy by विसर्ग
(B) ल ल ल ग — only the last syllable is heavy (C) ग ग ग ग — every syllable is heavy
(D) ल ग ग ल — द्रः is light because अ is short

25. Scan मन्त्रिणः (मन् + त्रि + णः) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ग ल ग — मन् heavy by the conjunct त्रि, त्रि light, णः heavy by विसर्ग
(B) ल ल ग — मन् is light because अ is short (C) ग ग ग — त्रि is heavy because of its conjunct त्र
(D) ग ल ल — the last syllable is light

26. Scan गोविन्दराजः (गो + विन् + द + रा + जः) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ग ल ल ग ग — विन् is light because इ is short
(B) ग ग ल ग ग — गो heavy by long ओ, विन् heavy by the conjunct न्द, द light, रा heavy by long आ, जः heavy by विसर्ग
(C) ग ग ल ग ल — the final जः is light (D) ल ग ल ग ग — गो is light because ओ is short

27. Scan सत्यनारायणः (सत् + य + ना + रा + य + णः) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ल ल ग ग ल ग — सत् is light because अ is short
(B) ग ग ग ग ल ग — य (second syllable) is heavy
(C) ग ल ग ग ल ग — सत् heavy by the conjunct त्य, य light, ना heavy by long आ, रा heavy by long आ, य light, णः heavy by विसर्ग
(D) ग ल ग ग ल ल — the final णः is light

28. Scan कौसल्या (कौ + सल् + या) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ग ग ग — कौ heavy by long औ, सल् heavy by the conjunct ल्य, या heavy by long आ
(B) ल ग ग — कौ is light because औ is short (C) ग ग ल — the final या is light
(D) ग ल ग — सल् is light

29. Scan धैर्यवान् (धैर् + य + वान्) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ल ल ग — धैर् is light because ऐ is short (B) ग ल ल — the final वान् is light
(C) ग ग ग — य is heavy
(D) ग ल ग — धैर् heavy (long ऐ and also the conjunct र्य), य light, वान् heavy by the final न्

30. Scan लक्ष्मीकान्तः (लक्ष् + मी + कान् + तः) into लघु/गुरु.

- (A) ल ग ग ग — लक्ष् is light because अ is short
(B) ग ग ग ग — लक्ष् heavy by the conjunct क्ष, मी heavy by long ई, कान् heavy (long आ and the conjunct न्त), तः heavy by विसर्ग
(C) ग ग ग ल — the final तः is light (D) ग ल ग ग — मी is light

31. In the word रश्मिः the syllable रश् carries a short अ. By the weight rules, रश् is:

- (A) गुरु (heavy) by position — the short अ is closed by the following conjunct श्म
- (B) लघु (light) — a syllable built on short अ is always light
- (C) गुरु (heavy) by nature — because अ is itself a long vowel
- (D) लघु (light) — only अनुस्वार or विसर्ग can make a syllable heavy, never a conjunct

32. In the word प्रज्ञा the first written unit प्र carries a short अ that is followed by the conjunct ज्ञ; the second unit ज्ञा carries a long आ. Classify the syllable प्र.

- (A) लघु (light) — प्र itself contains the conjunct प्र, but conjuncts never affect weight
- (B) गुरु (heavy) by nature — because the आ of the word makes the whole word heavy
- (C) लघु (light) — the short अ is never closed because आ follows
- (D) गुरु (heavy) by position — the short अ of प्र is closed by the following conjunct ज्ञ

33. In the word पुनः the syllable पु carries short उ and the syllable नः carries short अ before विसर्ग. Which syllable is गुरु and why?

- (A) Only नः is गुरु — its short अ is closed by विसर्ग (heavy by position); पु has short उ before a single onset, so it stays लघु
- (B) Only पु is गुरु — because उ is a long vowel
- (C) Both are गुरु — every syllable of the word is heavy
- (D) Neither is गुरु — both vowels are short and विसर्ग is silent

34. In the word उत्सवः the first syllable उत् carries short उ before the conjunct त्स. Its weight is:

- (A) लघु (light) — a word-initial syllable can never be heavy
- (B) गुरु (heavy) by position — the short उ is closed by the following conjunct त्स
- (C) गुरु (heavy) by nature — because उ is long
- (D) लघु (light) — conjuncts only matter in the middle of a word

35. In the word वंशः the first syllable वं carries short अ before अनुस्वार (ं), and शः carries short अ before विसर्ग. How many of the two syllables are गुरु?

- (A) Only शः — अनुस्वार is silent and changes nothing
- (B) Only वं — विसर्ग does not affect weight
- (C) Neither — both vowels are short, so both are light
- (D) Both — वं is heavy because अनुस्वार closes the short अ, and शः is heavy because विसर्ग closes the short अ

36. In the word क्रिया the unit क्रि carries short इ and the unit या carries long आ. The conjunct क्र begins the word. Classify क्रि.

- (A) गुरु (heavy) — the conjunct क्र makes the syllable heavy
- (B) गुरु (heavy) — because इ is a long vowel
- (C) गुरु (heavy) — any syllable preceding a long आ is heavy
- (D) लघु (light) — its short इ is closed by nothing (the conjunct क्र is an onset BEFORE the vowel, and only the single onset य follows), so क्रि stays light

37. In the word बिम्बम् the first syllable बिम् carries short इ before अनुस्वार, and the last बम् carries short अ before the final म्. The scansion is:

- (A) लघु-लघु — both vowels are short (B) गुरु-लघु — only the first syllable is heavy
(C) गुरु-गुरु — बिम् heavy by अनुस्वार, बम् heavy by the word-final consonant म्
(D) लघु-गुरु — only the last syllable is heavy

38. The vowel अ (as in कमल) is produced from which place of articulation (उच्चारण-स्थान)?

- (A) ओष्ठ (lips) — अ is ओष्ठ्य (B) कण्ठ (throat) — अ is कण्ठ्य (guttural)
(C) तालु (palate) — अ is तालव्य (D) मूर्धा (hard palate / roof) — अ is मूर्धन्य

39. The vowels इ and ई are produced from which उच्चारण-स्थान?

- (A) कण्ठ (throat) — इ ई are कण्ठ्य (B) ओष्ठ (lips) — इ ई are ओष्ठ्य
(C) दन्त (teeth) — इ ई are दन्त्य (D) तालु (palate) — इ ई are तालव्य (palatal)

40. The vowels उ and ऊ are produced from which उच्चारण-स्थान?

- (A) तालु (palate) — उ ऊ are तालव्य (B) कण्ठ (throat) — उ ऊ are कण्ठ्य
(C) ओष्ठ (lips) — उ ऊ are ओष्ठ्य (labial) (D) मूर्धा (roof) — उ ऊ are मूर्धन्य

41. The consonants ट ठ ड ढ ण (the ट-वर्ग) are produced from which उच्चारण-स्थान?

- (A) दन्त (teeth) — they are दन्त्य (B) ओष्ठ (lips) — they are ओष्ठ्य
(C) मूर्धा (the hard palate / roof of the mouth) — they are मूर्धन्य (retroflex)
(D) कण्ठ (throat) — they are कण्ठ्य

42. The consonants त थ द ध न (the त-वर्ग) are produced from which उच्चारण-स्थान?

- (A) मूर्धा (roof) — they are मूर्धन्य (B) दन्त (teeth) — they are दन्त्य (dental)
(C) तालु (palate) — they are तालव्य (D) कण्ठ (throat) — they are कण्ठ्य

43. The consonants क ख ग घ ङ (the क-वर्ग) are produced from which उच्चारण-स्थान?

- (A) तालु (palate) — they are तालव्य (B) ओष्ठ (lips) — they are ओष्ठ्य
(C) कण्ठ (throat) — they are कण्ठ्य (guttural) (D) दन्त (teeth) — they are दन्त्य

44. Which वर्ण-and-स्थान pairing is CORRECT?

- (A) प फ ब भ म (प-वर्ग) are दन्त्य (dental) (B) च छ ज झ ञ (च-वर्ग) are तालव्य (palatal)
(C) ट ठ ड ढ ण (ट-वर्ग) are कण्ठ्य (guttural) (D) क ख ग घ ङ (क-वर्ग) are ओष्ठ्य (labial)

45. A student groups वर्ण into स्वर (vowels) and व्यञ्जन (consonants). Which list contains ONLY स्वर?

- (A) क, च, ट, त, प (the first letter of each वर्ग) (B) य, र, ल, व (the अन्तःस्थ / semivowels)
(C) ँ (अनुस्वार) and ः (विसर्ग) (D) अ, आ, इ, ई, उ, ऊ, ए, ऐ, ओ, औ

46. Among अ, आ, इ, ई, उ, ऊ, ए, ऐ, ओ, औ, exactly how many are दीर्घ (long, 2 मात्रा)?

- (A) Three — only आ, ई, ऊ (B) Five — आ, ई, ऊ, ए, ओ
(C) Seven — आ, ई, ऊ, ए, ऐ, ओ, औ (D) Four — only ऐ, औ, ए, ओ

47. The signs अनुस्वार (ं) and विसर्ग (ः) are best classified as:

- (A) स्वर (vowels) worth 2 मात्रा each (B) the longest प्लुत vowels, worth 3 मात्रा
 (C) व्यञ्जन that each begin their own syllable
 (D) अयोगवाह — dependent sounds that are neither full स्वर nor full व्यञ्जन; they add no मात्रा yet can make a preceding short vowel गुरु

48. In the syllable क, the vowel अ that sounds inside it and the consonant क that carries it differ in that:

- (A) अ is a स्वर (can be sounded alone and carries मात्रा), while क is a व्यञ्जन (needs a vowel to be pronounced and carries no मात्रा of its own)
 (B) both are स्वर, since both are written together
 (C) both are व्यञ्जन, since neither can stand alone
 (D) अ is a व्यञ्जन and क is a स्वर

49. By प्रयत्न (effort of articulation), क is a स्पर्श (stop) and य र ल व are अन्तःस्थ. Which statement is CORRECT?

- (A) क is an अन्तःस्थ, while य is a स्पर्श (full stop)
 (B) य र ल व are अन्तःस्थ (semivowels) — articulated with the organs nearly, but not fully, touching
 (C) all of क, य, र, ल, व are स्वर
 (D) श, ष, स are अन्तःस्थ, while य, र, ल, व are ऊष्म (sibilants)

50. A teacher contrasts the स्थान of इ and उ to explain why two different long vowels exist. The correct contrast is:

- (A) both इ and उ are कण्ठ्य; only their मात्रा differs
 (B) इ is ओष्ठ्य and उ is तालव्य (C) both are मूर्धन्य; the difference is only in pitch
 (D) इ (and ई) are तालव्य (palatal) while उ (and ऊ) are ओष्ठ्य (labial) — different places of articulation

51. Comparing वनम् (3 short अ vowels) and वीणा (long ई + long आ) for total मात्रा, which is longer and by how much?

- (A) वनम् is longer by 1 मात्रा because it has three syllables
 (B) they are equal — both have an even spread of vowels
 (C) वीणा is longer by 4 मात्रा
 (D) वीणा is longer by 1 मात्रा — वीणा = 2+2 = 4, while वनम् = 1+1+1 = 3

52. Two reciters scan the word अर्जुनः. One says गुरु-लघु-गुरु, the other लघु-लघु-गुरु. (अर् = short अ + conjunct र्ज, जु = short उ + single onset, नः = short अ + विसर्ग.) Who is right?

- (A) लघु-लघु-गुरु is right — अर् is light because अ is short
 (B) गुरु-लघु-गुरु is right — अर् heavy by the conjunct र्ज, जु light, नः heavy by विसर्ग
 (C) लघु-लघु-लघु is right — every vowel is short
 (D) गुरु-गुरु-गुरु is right — every syllable is heavy

53. A pupil counts कौशल्या as '3 syllables, so 3 मात्रा'. Recompute correctly. (Vowels: औ in कौ, अ in शल्, आ in या.)

- (A) 3 मात्रा — the pupil is right, one per syllable (B) 4 मात्रा — only the औ counts double
(C) 5 मात्रा — long औ 2, short अ 1, long आ 2 = 5 (D) 6 मात्रा — the conjunct ल्य adds one

54. A teacher writes: 'A प्लुत vowel is 3 मात्रा. A short vowel closed by अनुस्वार becomes 2 मात्रा of sound.' Which half, if either, is wrong?

- (A) The first half is wrong — a प्लुत is 2 मात्रा (B) Both halves are correct
(C) Both halves are wrong
(D) The second half is wrong — a short vowel stays 1 मात्रा even when अनुस्वार makes its syllable गुरु; weight is not added duration

55. When आ + आ combine in sandhi to a single long आ (e.g. विद्या + आलयः → विद्यालयः), what happens to the total vowel-duration at the junction?

- (A) It stays 4 मात्रा — vowel-time is always conserved in sandhi
(B) It rises to 6 मात्रा — the values add
(C) It drops from 4 मात्रा (2 + 2) to 2 मात्रा — two long vowels merge into one
(D) It becomes 3 मात्रा — the merged vowel is प्लुत

56. Why can two words that look almost identical, like a short-final form versus a प्लुत-final form (e.g. राम versus the call रामऽ-3), be sharply distinguished only by quantity?

- (A) Because vowel-quantity is phonemic in chant and address — holding the final vowel for 3 मात्रा marks it as a distinct प्लुत vocative, a meaning the 1-मात्रा short form does not carry
(B) Because the two forms differ in caste (वर्ण)
(C) Because the प्लुत form has an extra consonant the short form lacks
(D) Because quantity never changes meaning, so the two are simply the same word

57. A reciter must turn a final short इ into a प्लुत ईऽ-3 before a long pause. By how many मात्रा does that single vowel grow, and what is its final quantity-name?

- (A) It grows by 2 मात्रा (from 1 to 3) and becomes प्लुत (prolonged)
(B) It grows by 1 मात्रा (from 1 to 2) and becomes दीर्घ
(C) It does not change — इ cannot be lengthened
(D) It grows by 3 मात्रा (from 1 to 4), a new fourth quantity

58. Among the words राधा, हरिः, गुरुः and नदी, exactly one has BOTH its syllables गुरु. Which is it?

- (A) राधा — रा (long आ) and धा (long आ) are both गुरु by nature
(B) हरिः — ह light, रिः heavy by विसर्ग, so light-heavy
(C) गुरुः — गु light, रुः heavy by विसर्ग, so light-heavy
(D) नदी — न light, दी heavy by long ई, so light-heavy

59. Count the total मात्रा in the line गुरुः शिष्यम् बोधयति (vowels: उ in गु, उ in रुः, इ in शि, अ in ष्यम्, ओ in बो, अ in ध, अ in य, इ in ति).

(A) 8 मात्रा

(B) 10 मात्रा

(C) 7 मात्रा

(D) 9 मात्रा

60. Final synthesis — a student writes: 'ए is a short vowel; अनुस्वार adds one मात्रा; and a short उ before a conjunct stays लघु.' How many of the three claims are wrong?

(A) All three are wrong — ए is a दीर्घ vowel (2 मात्रा), अनुस्वार adds zero मात्रा, and a short उ closed by a conjunct becomes गुरु by position

(B) Only one is wrong

(C) Exactly two are wrong

(D) None is wrong

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity) — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	A	21	A	31	A	41	C	51	D
2	D	12	C	22	B	32	D	42	B	52	B
3	A	13	B	23	B	33	A	43	C	53	C
4	C	14	D	24	A	34	B	44	B	54	D
5	D	15	C	25	A	35	D	45	D	55	C
6	C	16	B	26	B	36	D	46	C	56	A
7	B	17	D	27	C	37	C	47	D	57	A
8	A	18	C	28	A	38	B	48	A	58	A
9	B	19	C	29	D	39	D	49	B	59	D
10	B	20	C	30	B	40	C	50	D	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) Sum each vowel's quantity-value, not the syllables: short अ is 1, short उ is 1, short ँ is 1, short ए is 1, short ओ is 1, giving $1+1+1+1+1 = 5$. Every vowel here is short. The conjunct न्द makes the नन् syllable heavy by position but adds no time, and the final विसर्ग adds none either — so the count cannot rise above five, and there is no long vowel to push it higher.

2. (D) Add each vowel by its own value: short अ 1, short अ 1, short अ 1, long ई 2 = 5. Only the final ई is long, so it alone carries 2; the three short अ vowels carry 1 each. Counting one unit per syllable would wrongly drop the long ई to 1 and give 4; the conjunct स्त्र contributes no time of its own.

3. (A) Two long आ vowels weigh 2 each and the two short अ vowels weigh 1 each: $2+2+1+1 = 6$. The trap is treating one or both long आ as a single unit (which would give 5 or 4). The final विसर्ग makes णः heavy by position but adds zero मात्रा.

4. (C) Treat the line as one chain of vowels: long आ 2, short अ 1, short अ 1, short अ 1 = 5. The विसर्ग on मः and the final consonant म् both create गुरु syllables by position but neither adds duration. Only the single long आ supplies the extra मात्रा above a naive four.

5. (D) Short अ 1, long आ 2, long ए 2, short अ 1 = 6. The decisive trap is ए: it is a दीर्घ (long) vowel worth 2, never short. Treating ए as 1 would give 5; the final विसर्ग adds nothing.

6. (C) औ is a long (दीर्घ) vowel worth 2; the two short अ vowels weigh 1 each: $2+1+1 = 4$. Counting one per syllable would treat औ as 1 and give 3. The final विसर्ग adds no मात्रा.

7. (B) Sum the vowels alone: short इ 1, long ओ 2, long आ 2, short अ 1 = 6. The conjuncts घ and त्स and the final विसर्ग add no time. Both ओ and आ are long (2 each); reading ओ as short would wrongly give 5.

8. (A) Across the whole line: long ऊ 2, short अ 1, short उ 1, long ए 2, short इ 1 = 7. The two long vowels (ऊ and ए) are worth 2 each; the rest are short. The conjunct र्य and the विसर्ग make syllables गुरु by position but add no मात्रा.

9. (B) The three vowels are long आ (2), short अ (1), long आ (2): $2+1+2 = 5$. Two of the three vowels are long; the conjunct षड and the final विसर्ग add no duration. A naive one-per-syllable count would give 3.

10. (B) All four vowels are short — उ 1, अ 1, अ 1, अ 1 = 4. There is no long vowel anywhere, so the total equals the syllable count here, and the word-final म् adds no मात्रा (it only makes the last syllable गुरु by position).

11. (A) Long ए 2, short अ 1, long आ 2, short अ 1, short अ 1 = 7. Two long vowels (ए and आ) carry 2 each; the three short अ carry 1 each. Mis-reading ए as short would give 6.

12. (C) Long आ 2, short अ 1, long ई 2, short अ 1 = 6. Two long vowels supply 2 each. Counting one per syllable would yield 4; the final विसर्ग adds nothing.

13. (B) Short अ 1, short अ 1, long ई 2, short अ 1 = 5. Only the दीर्घ ई is worth 2; the rest are short ones worth 1. The final विसर्ग adds no time.

14. (D) Sum every vowel across the line: long आ 2, long आ 2, short उ 1, short अ 1, short अ 1, short अ 1, short इ 1 = 9. Only the two आ are long; all five other vowels are short. The conjuncts त्र and श्य and the final म् add no duration.

15. (C) Three long vowels and one short: long ओ 2, long ई 2, long आ 2, short अ 1 = 7. Each of ओ, ई, आ is दीर्घ (2). Treating ओ as short would drop it to 6; the final विसर्ग adds nothing.

16. (B) Four short अ (1 each) and one long ए (2): $1+1+2+1+1 = 6$. Only ए is long. The conjunct ऋ and the final विसर्ग make syllables गुरु by position but never add मात्रा; reading ए as short would give 5.

17. (D) क and म each carry a short अ closed only by a single onset, so both are लघु. ला carries the long आ, so it is गुरु by nature. नि carries a short इ closed only by a single onset and stands open at word-end, so it is लघु. Hence light-light-heavy-light. The long आ is the only heavy syllable.

18. (C) वि has short इ; the conjunct घ begins the NEXT syllable (it is an onset, before its own vowel), so it does not close वि — therefore वि stays लघु. घा has the long आ, गुरु by nature. ल has short अ before a single onset, लघु. यः has short अ closed by विसर्ग, गुरु by position. Pattern light-heavy-light-heavy.

19. (C) दे has long ए (गुरु by nature). व has short अ before a single onset (लघु). दू has long ऊ (गुरु by nature). तः has short अ closed by विसर्ग (गुरु by position — विसर्ग closes the short vowel even though it adds no मात्रा). So heavy-light-heavy-heavy. The trap is calling तः light because its vowel is short — weight comes from the closing विसर्ग, not the vowel's length.

20. (C) The opening अ is short and open (nothing closes it), so लघु. न् has short अ closed by the conjunct त्त, गुरु by position. त has short अ before a single onset, लघु. र्म् has short अ closed by the word-final consonant म्, गुरु by position. Pattern light-heavy-light-heavy. All four vowels are short; weight here comes purely from what closes each vowel.

21. (A) पुस् has short उ closed by the conjunct स्त, गुरु by position. त has short अ before a single onset, लघु. का has long आ, गुरु by nature. ल has short अ before a single onset, लघु. यः has short अ closed by विसर्ग, गुरु by position. So heavy-light-heavy-light-heavy — a mix of one nature-गुरु and two position-गुरु.

22. (B) सङ् has short अ closed by the conjunct ङ्ग (गुरु by position). गी has long ई (गुरु by nature). तम् has short अ closed by the word-final म् (गुरु by position). All three are गुरु — two by position, one by nature. The trap is judging सङ् or तम् by their short vowels rather than by their closures.

23. (B) अम् has short अ closed by अनुस्वार — गुरु by position (अनुस्वार closes the vowel though it adds no time). बा long आ, गुरु by nature. लि short इ before a single onset, लघु. का long आ, गुरु by nature. Pattern heavy-heavy-light-heavy. The trap is thinking अनुस्वार, because it adds no मात्रा, also adds no weight — it does close the vowel.

24. (A) ह has short अ before a single onset, लघु. रिश् has short इ closed by the conjunct श्र (heavy by position). चन् has short अ closed by the conjunct न्द्र (heavy by position). द्रः has short अ closed by विसर्ग (heavy by position). Pattern light-heavy-heavy-heavy — three position-गुरु in a row though every vowel is short.

25. (A) म्न् has short अ closed by the conjunct न्न, गुरु by position. त्रि has short इ; its त्रि is an ONSET (before the vowel) and a single following consonant ण begins the next syllable, so त्रि is closed by nothing — लघु. णः has short अ closed by विसर्ग, गुरु by position. Pattern heavy-light-heavy. The trap is treating त्रि as heavy just because it contains a conjunct त्र — a conjunct before the vowel does not close it.

26. (B) गो long ओ (गुरु by nature). विन् short इ closed by the conjunct न्द (गुरु by position). द short अ before single onset (लघु). रा long आ (गुरु by nature). जः short अ closed by विसर्ग (गुरु by position). Pattern heavy-heavy-light-heavy-heavy. Two nature-गुरु, two position-गुरु, one लघु.

27. (C) सत् short अ closed by the conjunct त्य (गुरु by position). य short अ before single onset (लघु). ना and रा each long आ (गुरु by nature). य short अ before single onset (लघु). णः short अ closed by विसर्ग (गुरु by position). Pattern heavy-light-heavy-heavy-light-heavy.

28. (A) कौ has long औ (गुरु by nature). सल् has short अ closed by the conjunct त्य (गुरु by position). या has long आ (गुरु by nature). All three गुरु — two by nature, one by position. Calling कौ light is the diphthong-as-short trap.

29. (D) घैर् has long ऐ (गुरु by nature) and is additionally closed by the conjunct र्य (also by position) — heavy by either rule. य has short अ before a single onset, लघु. वान् has long आ AND is closed by the final न् — heavy by nature and position both. Pattern heavy-light-heavy.

30. (B) लक्ष् short अ closed by the conjunct क्ष (गुरु by position). मी long ई (गुरु by nature). कान् long आ plus the closing conjunct न्त (गुरु by nature and position). तः short अ closed by विसर्ग (गुरु by position). All four गुरु.

31. (A) अ is short, so रश् cannot be heavy by nature. But a short vowel closed by a following consonant cluster becomes heavy by position; here श्म closes रश्. So it is गुरु by position. A conjunct most certainly can trigger position-weight; it is not limited to अनुस्वार/विसर्ग.

32. (D) प्र = प् + र् + short अ; what follows this short अ is the conjunct ज्ञ, which closes it, so प्र is गुरु by position. The conjunct प्र at the start is merely the onset (before the vowel) and does not by itself decide weight; the long आ belongs to the next syllable, not to प्र.

33. (A) पु has short उ closed by only the single onset न्, so it is लघु. नः has short अ closed by विसर्ग, which makes it गुरु by position even though विसर्ग adds no मात्रा. So exactly one syllable, नः, is heavy. Being short does not stop a vowel from becoming position-गुरु when something closes it.

34. (B) उ is short, so उत् is not heavy by nature; but the following conjunct त्स closes the short उ, making उत् गुरु by position. Word position (initial/medial/final) is irrelevant to the rule — only what closes the vowel matters, and उ is short, not long.

35. (D) Both vowels are short, so neither is heavy by nature. But अनुस्वार closes वं and विसर्ग closes शः, and each closure produces गुरु by position. Neither अनुस्वार nor विसर्ग adds मात्रा, yet both make the preceding short vowel heavy — so both syllables are गुरु.

36. (D) Position-weight depends on what FOLLOWS the short vowel, not the cluster that precedes it. The conjunct ऋ is the onset of क्रि (before its इ); after the इ comes only the

single consonant य starting या. So nothing closes the short इ, and क्रि is लघु. A preceding cluster does not by itself make a syllable heavy.

37. (C) Both vowels are short, so neither is heavy by nature. बिम् is closed by अनुस्वार (गुरु by position); बम् is closed by the word-final consonant म् (गुरु by position). A word-final consonant closes the vowel just as a conjunct or अनुस्वार does. Pattern गुरु-गुरु.

38. (B) By the traditional उच्चारण-स्थान scheme, अ and आ are कण्ठ्य — sounded from the throat. They are not lip-sounds (those are उ ऊ and प-वर्ग), not palatal (those are इ ई and च-वर्ग), and not retroflex. So the place of articulation for अ is the कण्ठ.

39. (D) इ and ई are तालव्य — sounded at the palate, the same place as the च-वर्ग consonants (च छ ज झ ञ) and the semivowel य. They are not throat-sounds (those are अ आ) nor lip-sounds (उ ऊ).

40. (C) उ and ऊ are ओष्ठ्य — sounded with the lips, the same place as the प-वर्ग consonants (प फ ब भ म). They are not palatal (इ ई) nor throat-sounds (अ आ).

41. (C) The ट-वर्ग is मूर्धन्य — the tongue curls back to touch the मूर्धा (the hard palate/roof). The त-वर्ग (त थ द ध न) is the दन्त्य (dental) set; the प-वर्ग is ओष्ठ्य; the क-वर्ग is कण्ठ्य.

42. (B) The त-वर्ग is दन्त्य — the tongue-tip touches the teeth. This is distinct from the retroflex ट-वर्ग (मूर्धन्य), the palatal च-वर्ग (तालव्य), and the guttural क-वर्ग (कण्ठ्य). A common slip is confusing the दन्त्य त-वर्ग with the मूर्धन्य ट-वर्ग.

43. (C) The क-वर्ग is कण्ठ्य — sounded from the throat, the same place as the vowels अ आ and the visarga/ह. The च-वर्ग is तालव्य, the प-वर्ग is ओष्ठ्य, and the त-वर्ग is दन्त्य.

44. (B) The च-वर्ग is तालव्य — correct. The प-वर्ग is ओष्ठ्य (lips), not दन्त्य; the ट-वर्ग is मूर्धन्य, not कण्ठ्य; the क-वर्ग is कण्ठ्य, not ओष्ठ्य. Each wrong option swaps a वर्ग to the wrong place of articulation.

45. (D) स्वर are the vowels — they can be sounded on their own and carry मात्रा: अ आ इ ई उ ऊ ए ऐ ओ औ. The वर्ग-initial consonants and the semivowels य र ल व are व्यञ्जन; अनुस्वार and विसर्ग are dependent signs (अयोगवाह), not स्वर at all.

46. (C) The short vowels are अ, इ, उ (three of them, 1 मात्रा each). Everything else in the list is long: आ, ई, ऊ are the long counterparts, and ए, ऐ, ओ, औ are all दीर्घ as well — seven long vowels in total. The frequent error is forgetting that ए ऐ ओ औ count as long.

47. (D) अनुस्वार and विसर्ग are अयोगवाह — they depend on a preceding vowel and are classed apart from the ten स्वर and the व्यञ्जन. They carry no मात्रा of their own, but they close a preceding short vowel and so can turn its syllable गुरु by position. They are not vowels worth 2, nor प्लुत, nor independent consonants.

48. (A) A स्वर (vowel) such as अ can be sounded on its own and is what carries मात्रा. A व्यञ्जन (consonant) such as क cannot be sounded without a supporting vowel and adds no मात्रा by itself. So the bare क-sound is a व्यञ्जन while the अ inside it is the स्वर supplying the duration.

49. (B) The अन्तःस्थ ('in-between') sounds are य र ल व — produced with a near-contact, between full stops and open vowels. क is a स्पर्श (full stop), not an अन्तःस्थ; none of these are स्वर; and श ष स (plus ह) are the ऊष्म (sibilant/spirant) class, the opposite assignment to what the wrong option states.

50. (D) इ/ई are sounded at the palate (तालव्य) and उ/ऊ are sounded with the lips (ओष्ठ्य) — genuinely different places of articulation, which is why they are distinct vowels rather than mere length-variants of one another. Neither is कण्ठ्य (that is अ आ) nor मूर्धन्य.

51. (D) वनम् has three short अ vowels = 3 मात्रा (the final म् adds no time). वीणा has long ई (2) and long आ (2) = 4 मात्रा. So वीणा exceeds वनम् by $4 - 3 = 1$ मात्रा, even though वनम् has more syllables — duration follows vowel-length, not syllable-count.

52. (B) अर् has short अ closed by the conjunct र्ज, so गुरु by position. जु has short उ closed only by a single onset न, so लघु. नः has short अ closed by विसर्ग, गुरु by position. Pattern heavy-light-heavy. Calling अर् light ignores that the conjunct र्ज closes its short vowel.

53. (C) Add each vowel: long औ is 2, short अ is 1, long आ is 2 $\rightarrow 2+1+2 = 5$. Two of the three vowels are long. The conjunct ल्य makes शल् गुरु by position but adds no मात्रा, so it cannot raise the total to 6; and ignoring the diphthong-length gives the wrong 3.

54. (D) A प्लुत is indeed 3 मात्रा, so the first half is right. But position-weight (here from अनुस्वार) changes syllable WEIGHT, not the vowel's DURATION: the short vowel is still 1 मात्रा. Confusing 'heavy' with 'longer' is the misconception — अनुस्वार adds zero मात्रा.

55. (C) Before junction the two long आ vowels total $2 + 2 = 4$ मात्रा. They merge into a single long आ worth 2. So the duration falls from 4 to 2; sandhi does not always conserve total vowel-time. The merged vowel is दीर्घ (2), not प्लुत (3).

56. (A) The forms differ only in how long the final vowel is held: a short (1 मात्रा) form versus a प्लुत (3 मात्रा) drawn-out vocative used in calling. Because quantity is phonemic here, length alone signals the distinct vocative/chant function. वर्ण means sound (not caste), and no consonant is added; quantity certainly can change function.

57. (A) A short इ is 1 मात्रा; held as a प्लुत it becomes 3 मात्रा — an increase of $3 - 1 = 2$. The result is प्लुत, the third quantity. Going only to 2 मात्रा would be दीर्घ; there is no 4-मात्रा fourth class in Sanskrit.

58. (A) राधा has two long आ vowels, so both रा and धा are गुरु by nature — गुरु-गुरु. हरिः is light-heavy (short ह, then short इ closed by विसर्ग). गुरुः is light-heavy likewise. नदी is light-heavy (short अ, then long ई). Only राधा is heavy-heavy.

59. (D) Sum every vowel across the line: short उ 1, short उ 1, short इ 1, short अ 1, long ओ 2, short अ 1, short अ 1, short इ 1 = 9. Only ओ is long (worth 2); the other seven vowels are short. The conjuncts ष्य and the final म् add no time, and the विसर्ग on रु: makes that syllable गुरु by position but adds no मात्रा.

60. (A) Claim 1 fails: ए is long (2 मात्रा), not short. Claim 2 fails: अनुस्वार contributes no मात्रा (it only forces position-weight). Claim 3 fails: a short उ closed by a following conjunct becomes गुरु by position, not लघु. All three are errors.